

Fall 2026 weekday bus requirement: fleet certification

To: MBTA Board of Directors From: Service Planning, schedule certification Date: 5 October 2026

Certified requirement

The Board should certify the Fall 2026 weekday bus requirement at **621 buses**, +14 against the Summer 2026 certification of 607. The peak falls in the morning, at 07:51; the Summer peak fell at 07:59. The same files and the same convention reproduce the Summer certification of 607 exactly. Finance's draft peak of 521 is not certified. The schedule behind the fleet change is a net +321 weekday trips, 12,721 to 13,042, which is Finance's figure and is certified; the planners' +149 is not. **Route 65** (Brighton Center - Ruggles Station) is the single route behind the biggest share of the change at +45 trips.

The three figures, what each counted, and the certification decision

Finance's peak of 521 buses: not certified. It is the most trips underway at one moment, at 17:26 in the afternoon (the Summer equivalent is 513 at 17:26). Under the convention a bus is in service from the first departure to the last arrival of its day's work, so a bus on layover between trips is still out. Trips underway run about a hundred below buses out and peak in the afternoon, when trips are long, not in the morning, when the most buses are out.

Finance's +321 weekday trips: certified. It compares the weekday schedule that ran for most of the Summer rating (12,721 trips, the no school weekday, 34 of the rating's 48 Monday to Thursday dates) with the weekday schedule that runs for most of the Fall rating (13,042 trips, 52 of 55 dates). That is the convention's certification day for each rating, and the figure stands.

The planners' +149: not certified. It replaces the Summer certification day with the Summer rating's school day weekday (12,893 trips, 10 of 48 dates, the weeks either side of the school holiday) to make a like for like school day comparison with Fall. The comparison is arithmetically correct and it is not the Board's convention, which certifies each rating on the schedule it mostly ran. On the planners' basis the Summer peak would be 615 buses, which does not reproduce the certified 607; the certified figures are not adjusted.

How the certified figures were built

The archive index assigns the feed published 12 August 2026 to 19 August, the Summer certification day, and the published Fall feed (the archive's 25 September entry) to 30 September, the Fall certification day. The Summer rating's Monday to Thursday dates split 34 on the no school weekday schedule, 10 on the school day schedule and 4 on transition variants, read from the June feed, whose calendar carries the whole rating from 14 June; the August feed's calendar starts on 12 August and alone would understate how long the no school schedule ran. The Fall rating runs one weekday schedule on 52 of 55 dates. Both days carry no holiday, modified or reduced service. Services were taken by date rather than by rating label. The route population is every route the feed classifies as Frequent, Local, Coverage, Commuter or Supplemental Bus; rail replacement shuttles are excluded and none ran on either day. Each trip was assigned to its block, each block counted as one bus from its first departure to its last arrival, and the count taken at every minute. Every figure is identical on every other qualifying day of its rating and in every archived feed that covers it.

Pull outs through the day

Under both ratings the hour with the most pull outs is the **05:00 hour**: 260 buses under Summer and 266 under Fall. The hour whose pull outs grew the most is the **14:00 hour, +34** (165 to 199), ahead of the 06:00 hour at +30. The Fall rating runs 1,824 pull outs against 1,819 under Summer. The full profile is in `weekday_bus_requirement.csv`.

Routes whose weekday trip count changed, ranked by size of change (59 of 152 routes)

Rank	Route	Category	Summer	Fall	Change
1	65	Local Bus	86	131	+45
2	465	Local Bus	0	32	+32
3	66	Frequent Bus	216	247	+31
4	70	Local Bus	147	172	+25
5	222	Local Bus	62	83	+21

Rank	Route	Category	Summer	Fall	Change
6	220	Local Bus	62	81	+19
7	39	Frequent Bus	215	229	+14
8	32	Frequent Bus	289	302	+13
9	429	Local Bus	39	51	+12
10	SLW	Frequent Bus	63	53	-10
11	26	Local Bus	82	72	-10
12	15	Frequent Bus	199	207	+8
13	19	Local Bus	54	62	+8
14	57	Frequent Bus	243	251	+8
15	101	Local Bus	104	111	+7
16	134	Local Bus	43	50	+7
17	216	Local Bus	140	147	+7
18	16	Local Bus	209	215	+6
19	23	Frequent Bus	241	247	+6
20	504	Commuter Bus	72	66	-6
21	35	Local Bus	68	73	+5
22	36	Local Bus	97	102	+5
23	38	Local Bus	54	59	+5
24	108	Local Bus	68	73	+5
25	95	Local Bus	74	78	+4
26	225	Local Bus	90	94	+4
27	426	Local Bus	49	53	+4
28	9	Frequent Bus	202	205	+3
29	22	Frequent Bus	206	209	+3
30	28	Frequent Bus	203	206	+3
31	77	Frequent Bus	186	189	+3
32	435	Local Bus	35	38	+3
33	501	Commuter Bus	49	52	+3
34	7	Local Bus	147	149	+2
35	8	Local Bus	75	77	+2
36	10	Local Bus	82	84	+2
37	21	Local Bus	150	152	+2
38	24	Local Bus	67	65	-2
39	34	Local Bus	94	92	-2
40	34E	Local Bus	78	80	+2
41	37	Local Bus	60	62	+2
42	41	Local Bus	49	51	+2
43	83	Local Bus	88	90	+2
44	88	Local Bus	94	96	+2
45	116	Frequent Bus	253	255	+2
46	201	Local Bus	71	73	+2
47	215	Local Bus	77	79	+2
48	436	Local Bus	31	33	+2
49	553	Local Bus	40	38	-2
50	44	Local Bus	101	100	-1
51	45	Local Bus	104	105	+1
52	69	Local Bus	109	110	+1
53	94	Local Bus	58	59	+1
54	137	Local Bus	58	59	+1
55	211	Local Bus	45	46	+1
56	217	Coverage Bus	8	9	+1
57	245	Local Bus	32	33	+1
58	430	Local Bus	38	39	+1
59	455	Local Bus	80	81	+1
All bus routes 152 routes			12,721	13,042	+321

The other 93 bus routes run the same number of weekday trips under both ratings, and the 59 changes sum to +321.

Route 65: what changed

Under the Summer rating 22 buses carry Route 65 trips during the weekday; under the Fall rating 33 do. Summer service ran 86 trips with the first departure at 05:58 and the last arrival at 21:03; Fall runs 131 trips from 05:00 to 25:33 (01:33 the next morning). The route was extended at its inbound end: Summer inbound trips end at Kenmore (headsign Kenmore) and Fall inbound trips end at Ruggles (headsign Ruggles), with the span opening about an hour earlier and closing more than four hours later. The added trips come from the longer span and more frequent service through the day, not from the Brighton Center end.

How close the driving route is to being overtaken

Route 465 (Danvers Square - Salem Depot via Liberty Tree Mall) is the runner up at +32, 13 trips behind, with Route 66 next at +31. The smallest change in a single route's Fall trip count that would make a different route the driver is **14 trips**: Route 465 at 46 Fall trips (+46), or Route 65 at 117 (+31), which would put Route 465 first.

Why no other figure survives

The convention fixes the unit, the day type, the day of week band, the population and the certification day, and the feed fixes which services run on each date and which trips share a bus. Applied together they give one Summer profile and one Fall profile, stable across every qualifying day and every archived feed, and the Summer profile returns the certified 607 exactly. Every other figure relaxes one fixed point: trips underway instead of buses out, the school day weeks instead of the schedule that ran the rating, a rating label instead of a date, or a Friday. 621 buses, +14, is the only requirement the convention and the files allow.